

The Founder Operating System — One-Page Map

The Brand Blueprint is your founder-facing ecosystem, Value Growth Partners is the advisory and execution engine behind it, and Growth OS turns plans into operating infrastructure. This map names the five layers a founder-led company runs on, and what it looks like when each one is carried by the founder personally instead of by the business.

Layer	What it covers	Founder-dependent looks like	Business-carried looks like
Direction	Where the company is going and why	Priorities change with whoever spoke to you last	Four written quarterly priorities the team can recite.
Demand	How customers find you and decide to buy	Revenue tracks your personal selling hours	A repeatable path that runs when you are away.
Delivery	How the product gets made, packaged, and shipped	You are the escalation point for every exception	Documented steps and a named owner per step.
Money	Cash, margin, runway, and the number of months left	You are behind the balance, not the forecast	A rolling forecast reviewed on a fixed date.
Rhythm	The meetings and reviews that keep the plan on track	Everything happens when something breaks	Weekly, monthly, and quarterly loops that hold.

How to use this map

- Score each layer honestly today: founder-dependent, partly carried, or business-carried.
- Expect two or three to be founder-dependent. That is normal and not a failing.
- Choose **one** to move this quarter. Moving one layer properly beats nudging five.
- Re-score at each quarterly reset. The map is a trend line, not a verdict.

Where each layer is served in the library

Layer	Collection
Direction	Start Here + Founder Operating Cadence · Growth OS + Founder Systems
Demand	Marketing, Content + Customer Growth · Retail, Buyers + Distribution
Delivery	Product, Packaging + Operations
Money	Funding + Capital Access
Rhythm	Start Here + Founder Operating Cadence

A layer that stays founder-dependent for four consecutive quarters is usually a hiring or partner question rather than a documentation question. The Partner Network collection exists for exactly that case.

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